NCFE Functional Skills Qualification in English at Level 2 – Reading (600/0140/9)

Sample Mark Scheme: P000296

Q	Reading	Marks	Coverage & Range	F/MC/O
Document 1				
1	**C** to help people decide whether to buy a laptop or tablet	1	2.2.3	F (MC)
2	**Any two from:** • Long battery life • Small screen size • Light weight • Quick start up speed • Easier to watch when standing on a train or relaxing on the couch • Can use them at home or on the move Accept similar wording.	2	2.2.2	O
3	**Any two from:** • Can use them for work and play • Laptops are versatile • They have more powerful processors • They have 4GB or more of Ram • They are better for multi-tasking • They are able to run full programmes at a decent speed • There is more storage space on a laptop • Laptops have larger screens • Laptops have larger/easier to use keyboards • Laptops are easier to connect to other devices Accept similar wording.	2	2.2.2	O
4	**One mark for each** of the following points: • A tablet would be best for this purpose (watching films and TV when out and about) • Any from: Long battery life; small screen size; easier to hold/watch Accept similar wording although **answers must include words/phrases taken from the source document.**	2	2.2.1	O

SAMPLE

<table>
<tr><th>Q</th><th>Reading</th><th>Marks</th><th>Coverage & Range</th><th>F/MC/O</th></tr>
<tr><td>5</td><td>Any two from:

• ‘If you’ve previously owned a PC or laptop you might find it hard to get by with just a tablet.’
• ‘not all websites work seamlessly with tablets’
• ‘they’re harder to connect to other devices’
• ‘Typing and entering information is made far more difficult on a smaller screen and without a keyboard’
• ‘…Windows still can’t compete with the larger screen and better processor on a laptop for working.’
• “For many tasks, such as creating a spreadsheet or editing photos, tablet Apps are just not good enough”
• “…more storage space on a laptop”

Answers must include words/phrases taken from the source document.</td><td>2</td><td>2.2.2</td><td>F</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="5">Document 2</td></tr>
<tr><td>6</td><td>D

you wanted to buy one of the most highly rated tablets</td><td>1</td><td>2.2.3</td><td>F (MC)</td></tr>
<tr><td>7</td><td>One mark for each of the following points:

[The Xperian Z2]
• Experiences occasionally delayed web browsing
• The screen is poor under natural light

Accept similar wording.</td><td>2</td><td>2.2.1</td><td>F</td></tr>
<tr><td>8</td><td>One mark for each of the following points:

<table>
<tr><th></th><th>Fact</th><th>Opinion</th></tr>
<tr><td>Sound quality through the new speaker has deteriorated…</td><td>X</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>…we found the Tab Mini-style case loses the first-class feel of past generations of Tab design.</td><td></td><td>X</td></tr>
<tr><td>The latest programme design, not loved by many, can’t be avoided on this device…</td><td>X</td><td></td></tr>
</table>
</td><td>3</td><td>2.2.4</td><td>F</td></tr>
</table>

SAMPLE

Q	Reading	Marks	Coverage & Range	F/MC/O
9	'[The writer uses the word 'staggeringly]' to highlight or emphasise the lightness of the tablet. Accept similar wording.	1	2.2.3	O
10	**One mark for each** of the following points: • The second document is most helpful in finding out about specific tablets as it breaks down each tablet, giving a brief review of the pros and cons of each; enabling the reader to make an informed choice. • The first document provides more general information. Accept similar wording.	**2 or 0**	2.2.5	O
Document 3				
11	**B** Tab management/head office	1	2.2.3	F (MC)
12	**One mark** for: • Angry/frustrated/dissatisfied/annoyed or similar. Accept any appropriate functional response **One further mark** for: • Providing a clear explanation of the emotion above using examples/evidence from the text to support the answer, such as: – The italics stress his frustration – The rhetorical question shows his annoyance – The phrase 'I might add' or 'parting with my hard-earned cash (again) show this. **Accept any functional response but note that correct answers to this question can only be derived from the first two paragraphs of the source text.**	2	2.2.5	O

SAMPLE

Q	Reading	Marks	Coverage & Range	F/MC/O
13	Award **one mark** for identification of **each** of the following main points up to a maximum of 3 points: • He wants a Tab that works • Manjit bought a Tab Mini a year and a half ago • 5 months after the warranty had run out it had stopped switching on • He paid £270 for a replacement with a 3-month warranty • This has now stopped working • Manjit had been informed that the warranty was not updated and so is invalid • He feels very disappointed/cheated/falsely advised and would like further help from Tab Accept similar wording.	3	2.2.2	O
14	”As you can guess, I feel more than a little cheated by this turn of events and feel hugely let down by Tab.” Accept shorter extracts that contain “more than a little cheated” and/or “feel hugely let down”.	1	2.2.4	F
15	Award **one mark** for **each** of the following points: • Manjit would like Tab to send him a new/working Tab • Manjit would like a decent warranty period given with the new/working Tab Accept similar wording.	2	2.2.5	O
16	Award **1 mark** for **each** reasonable piece of advice to a friend thinking of buying a tablet. Only one mark is available for advice from each document, eg: • Doc 1 advice will be about differences between choosing a tablet and laptop. • Doc 2 advice will be about specific products. • Doc 3 will be about warranties.	3	2.2.1	O

Total marks:	30
Pass mark:	22

SAMPLE

Test Specification

Skill standard	Coverage and range	No of questions	Total marks	Question type
Select, read, understand and compare texts and use them to gather information, ideas, arguments and opinions	2.2.1 Select and use different types of texts to obtain and utilise relevant information	3	7	11 Fixed response marks (3 including multiple-choice (MC)) 19 Open response (O)
	2.2.2 Summarise information/ideas from different sources	4	9	
	2.2.3 Identify the purposes of texts and comment on how meaning is conveyed	4	4	
	2.2.4 Detect point of view, implicit meaning and/or bias	2	4	
	2.2.5 Analyse texts in relation to audience needs and consider suitable responses	3	6	
		16	**30**	

The assessment covers 100% of the coverage and range.

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